

D161

Nursing Leadership and Management Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A falls-reduction project on an orthopedic unit that recently hired a new manager began with a baseline of 12 falls per 1,000 patient days. After six months the rate is 8 falls per 1,000 patient days. The hospital's overall rate is 5. What percent change should the final report show for the unit?

- A. A 58.3% decrease.
- B. A 33.3% decrease.
- C. A 4% decrease.
- D. A 50% decrease.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A unit's final report shows a 25% decrease in its infection rate, to 6.0 per 1,000 device days. What was the baseline rate?

- A. 8.0
- B. 7.5
- C. 4.5
- D. 24

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

3.

A capstone project at a busy urban ED, presented at a regional conference, reduced average door-to-triage time from 11.0 to 10.2 minutes across 4,000 patients, with $p = 0.03$. The ED has 45 beds. What is the most accurate interpretation?

- A. The difference is statistically significant, but whether 0.8 minutes is clinically meaningful must be judged separately.
- B. The result is not significant because the change is under 1 minute.
- C. The result proves the project works in every ED.
- D. The change is clinically important because p is below 0.05.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A small pilot with 40 patients found a 15% drop in readmissions, with $p = 0.20$. What is the best conclusion?

- A.** The project had no effect.
- B.** The 15% drop is due to chance 20% of the time, so it is 80% certain.
- C.** The result is significant because 15% is a large drop.
- D.** The result is not statistically significant, but the effect may be real; a larger sample is needed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A medication-reconciliation project has met its targets. The student lead, who is moving to a new city next month, has given her final presentation to the nursing leadership council, which meets in the boardroom. Which step is still needed to properly close the project?

- A.** Postpone closure until the lead returns from her move.
- B.** Obtain sponsor sign-off, hand off ownership and monitoring to an operational leader, and archive project records.
- C.** Nothing; the final presentation closes the project.
- D.** Start planning the next project's charter.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A pilot of hourly purposeful rounding cut call-light use by 30% on one unit. The project team, which includes two nurses who just finished their residency, will disband next month. What best protects the improvement after the team leaves?

- A.** Stop measuring, since the goal was met.
- B.** Keep the two newest nurses responsible for enforcing it.
- C.** Build rounding into policy, the EHR, and orientation; name a unit owner; and keep monitoring call-light data.
- D.** Rely on staff to continue since the results were good.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A capstone team is writing its lessons-learned section. Staff training went smoothly, but go-live slipped three weeks because IT was not included until implementation. The team's sponsor recently received a leadership award. Which entry best meets the purpose of lessons learned?

- A. "The sponsor's leadership ensured success."
- B. "Go-live slipped 3 weeks because IT joined at implementation; include IT in planning for any EHR-dependent project."
- C. "IT caused the delay."
- D. "Training went smoothly and the project succeeded."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A nurse leader who recently moved into a corner office selects the KPIs, data sources, and collection schedule that will later be used to judge whether her project succeeded. Her project is funded by a small foundation grant. In which phase does this work belong?

- A. Evaluation.
- B. Implementation.
- C. Planning.
- D. Initiation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity belongs in the initiation phase of a healthcare improvement project?

- A. Building the detailed schedule and communication plan.
- B. Training staff on the new workflow.
- C. Writing lessons learned.
- D. Developing the business case that establishes need and feasibility.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A nurse leader has 10 minutes to present her project's final results to the executive team, which meets on the top floor. The project ran 14 months, included 3 units, and survived a vendor change. How should she open?

- A.** Present every data table so nothing is left out.
- B.** Walk through the 14-month timeline in order, ending with results.
- C.** State the goal, the result against it, and her recommendation, then show supporting data.
- D.** Open with the story of the vendor change.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A unit's pressure injury rate fell 40% after a new turning-schedule project. During the same months, the hospital, which recently added valet parking, replaced every mattress system-wide, and rates also fell on units without the project. What is the most accurate conclusion?

- A.** Part or all of the drop may be due to the new mattresses; the project's own effect is uncertain.
- B.** The drop reflects better parking and less staff stress.
- C.** The project caused the full 40% drop.
- D.** The project had no effect.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which evaluation design best strengthens the claim that a project caused an improvement?

- A.** Comparing one month before with one month after.
- B.** Reporting only the post-implementation rate.
- C.** Asking staff whether they think the project worked.
- D.** Tracking the measure over time on the project unit and a similar comparison unit without the change.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A falls-reduction project on an orthopedic unit ~~that recently hired a new manager~~ began with a baseline of 12 falls per 1,000 patient days. After six months the rate is 8 falls per 1,000 patient days. ~~The hospital's overall rate is 5.~~ What percent change should the final report show for the unit?

Target word: percent change **Decides:** $(8 - 12) / 12$.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses the hospital's overall rate of 5 in place of the unit's result.
B	Correct	$(8 - 12) / 12 = -0.333$, a 33.3% decrease.
C	Dropped element	Reports the raw 4-point difference as a percent.
D	Inverted operation	Divides the change by the post value (8) instead of the baseline.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A unit's final report shows a 25% decrease in its infection rate, to 6.0 per 1,000 device days. What was the baseline rate?

Target word: solve for baseline **Decides:** $\text{Post} = \text{baseline} \times 0.75$.

A	Correct	$6.0 / 0.75 = 8.0$; $(6 - 8) / 8 = -25\%$.
B	Inverted operation	Adds 25% of the post value instead of dividing by 0.75.
C	Confusion set	Reduces the post value by 25% again.
D	Wrong stem number	Divides 6.0 by 0.25.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A capstone project at a busy urban ED, ~~presented at a regional conference~~, reduced average door-to-triage time from 11.0 to 10.2 minutes across 4,000 patients, with $p = 0.03$. ~~The ED has 45 beds.~~ What is the most accurate interpretation?

Target word: interpretation **Decides:** $p < 0.05$ but a 0.8-minute difference.

A	Correct	A small p-value shows the change is unlikely due to chance, not that it matters to patients.
B	Inverted operation	Effect size does not decide statistical significance; the p-value does.
C	Absolute language	One site's result does not prove universal effect.
D	Confusion set	Statistical significance does not measure importance.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A small pilot with 40 patients found a 15% drop in readmissions, with $p = 0.20$. What is the best conclusion?

Target word: reverse: non-significant result **Decides:** $p > 0.05$ with a large effect and small sample.

A	Absolute language	Non-significance is not proof of no effect.
B	Confusion set	Misreads the p-value as the probability the effect is real.
C	Inverted operation	A large effect does not make p significant.
D	Correct	A non-significant p does not prove no effect, especially with a small sample.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A medication-reconciliation project has met its targets. The student lead, ~~who is moving to a new city next month~~, has given her final presentation to the nursing leadership council, ~~which meets in the boardroom~~. Which step is still needed to properly close the project?

Target word: closure step **Decides:** Handoff, sponsor sign-off, and records remain.

A	Camouflage	Her move does not change which closure steps are needed.
B	Correct	Formal acceptance and handoff are core closure activities.
C	Dropped element	The presentation is one part of closure, not all of it.
D	Adjacent category	That is initiation of a new project, not closure of this one.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A pilot of hourly purposeful rounding cut call-light use by 30% on one unit. The project team, ~~which includes two nurses who just finished their residency~~, will disband next month. What best protects the improvement after the team leaves?

Target word: sustainability strategy **Decides:** Hardwire into standard work with an owner and ongoing measure.

A	Inverted operation	Ongoing measurement detects backsliding.
B	Camouflage	Singles out the residency detail instead of a formal owner and system.
C	Correct	Hardwiring and ongoing ownership sustain gains.
D	Dropped element	Without structure and an owner, practices drift back.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A capstone team is writing its lessons-learned section. Staff training went smoothly, but go-live slipped three weeks because IT was not included until implementation. ~~The team's sponsor recently received a leadership award~~. Which entry best meets the purpose of lessons learned?

Target word: quality of a lessons-learned entry **Decides:** Specific issue, root cause, and recommendation.

A	Camouflage	Answers the award detail rather than capturing a lesson.
B	Correct	Names the problem, cause, and a specific recommendation.
C	Inverted operation	Assigns blame instead of identifying the planning gap.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out the delay and offers no recommendation.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A nurse leader ~~who recently moved into a corner office~~ selects the KPIs, data sources, and collection schedule that will later be used to judge whether her project succeeded. ~~Her project is funded by a small foundation grant~~. In which phase does this work belong?

Target word: phase **Decides:** Choosing measures before implementation is planning.

A	Confusion set	Evaluation analyzes results using the measures chosen earlier.
B	Inverted operation	Implementation carries out the plan; measures must already exist.
C	Correct	Measures are chosen in planning so baseline and follow-up data can be collected.
D	Adjacent category	Initiation establishes need and feasibility, not the measurement plan.

9. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

Which activity belongs in the initiation phase of a healthcare improvement project?

Target word: reverse: activity from phase **Decides:** Initiation = need and feasibility.

A	Confusion set	Those are planning activities.
B	Adjacent category	Training happens in implementation.
C	Inverted operation	Lessons learned are written at closure.
D	Correct	The business case is an initiation activity.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A nurse leader has 10 minutes to present her project's final results to the executive team, ~~which meets on the top floor~~. The project ran 14 months, included 3 units, ~~and survived a vendor change~~. How should she open?

Target word: structure of the report **Decides:** Lead with the goal, result, and recommendation.

A	Absolute language	Detail belongs in an appendix.
B	Inverted operation	Puts the key message last.
C	Correct	Executives need the bottom line first.
D	Camouflage	An interesting detail, but not the decision leaders need.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A unit's pressure injury rate fell 40% after a new turning-schedule project. During the same months, the hospital, ~~which recently added valet parking~~, replaced every mattress system-wide, and rates also fell on units without the project. What is the most accurate conclusion?

Target word: attribution **Decides:** A concurrent system-wide change also lowered rates on comparison units.

A	Correct	A concurrent change that affected comparison units is a competing explanation.
B	Camouflage	Valet parking is irrelevant to pressure injuries.
C	Absolute language	Ignores the mattress change and comparison units.
D	Inverted operation	The data cannot rule out a partial project effect either.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

Which evaluation design best strengthens the claim that a project caused an improvement?

Target word: reverse: design that supports attribution **Decides:** Comparison group plus time-series data.

A	Dropped element	Two points cannot separate project effects from trends or chance.
B	Confusion set	Without a baseline there is nothing to compare.
C	Adjacent category	Opinion is a reaction measure, not evidence of cause.
D	Correct	A comparison group and repeated measures help separate the project effect from trends.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Percent change from baseline	Percent change = (post – baseline) / baseline × 100; always divide by the baseline.	Dividing by the post value, or reporting the raw difference as a percent.	A baseline and a post-implementation value for the same KPI.
2	Statistical vs. clinical significance	A p-value below 0.05 says a difference is unlikely to be due to chance; it does not say the difference is large enough to matter to patients, and a p-value above 0.05 does not prove there is no effect.	Equating “statistically significant” with “important,” or “not significant” with “no effect.”	A p-value reported next to a small or large effect size.
3	Project closure activities	Closing includes confirming deliverables with the sponsor, handing off to an operational owner, documenting lessons learned, releasing resources, and archiving project records.	Treating the final presentation as the whole of closure.	A project that has met its goals and is ending.
4	Sustaining the gains	Gains last when the change is hardwired into standard work (policy, EHR build, orientation), an owner is named, and a measure keeps being monitored with a response plan.	Assuming results will hold once the project team disbands.	A successful pilot about to be handed off.
5	Lessons learned	Lessons learned capture what went well and what did not in every phase, with root causes and specific recommendations for future projects.	Listing only successes, or blaming individuals.	A reflective report at the end of a project.
6	Project phases	Initiation (need, business case, charter), planning (objectives, measures, schedule, communication plan), implementation (training, go-live, managing the work), evaluation and closing (analyze results against KPIs, lessons learned, handoff).	Placing measure selection in evaluation or the business case in planning.	An activity that must be assigned to a phase.
7	Reporting results to leaders	Executive reports lead with the bottom line (goal, result, recommendation), then give supporting data; details go in an appendix.	Walking through the project chronologically and putting the result last.	A final presentation to senior leaders with limited time.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Attributing results to the project	Before crediting a project, consider other explanations such as secular trends, seasonal changes, or concurrent initiatives; comparison groups and time-series data strengthen attribution.	Assuming any improvement after go-live was caused by the project.	An improvement that coincides with another change or a system-wide trend.

Course scope (public description): The Nursing Leadership and Management Capstone provides students with an opportunity to evaluate and close their capstone project. This is the final course in the MSN Leadership and Management program. Students will evaluate the success of their healthcare improvement project (HIP) by analyzing results, using the key performance indicators and metrics that were identified while planning the evaluation phase. Students will present the results of the improvement project in a final report and presentation with a focus on lessons learned throughout each of the phases: initiation, planning, implementation, and evaluation. Reflective and analytic thinking are essential aspects of a capstone project, as students reflect and report on the successes and challenges encountered in each phase. Nursing Leadership and Management Field Experience is a prerequisite for this course. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see the Grading Scale Policy for more information.